Monster Creation Rules

This guide will assist you in creating your own monsters for the game Dragonbane, enhancing the encounters in your adventures. While the official Dragonbane bestiary is highly recommended, the following steps will help you design unique creatures of your own.

Step 1: Concept

Choose the name and concept for the monster you have in mind. Are you converting a monster from another tabletop role playing game or creating something new? Think about the monster and how it may fit into the world.

Step 2: Attributes

All monsters have 5 attributes (ferocity, size, movement, armor, and HP). Choose one option from the table below for each category. The more options you choose that are listed in one difficultly category will make the monster easier or harder to fight. A fairy is going to be on the weaker end of the scale. An ancient dragon is on the very hard end of the scale.

DIFFICULTY	FEROCITY	SIZE	MOVEMENT (SLOW-FAST)	ARMOR	HP
WEAK	1	Small	6-8	0	6-16
NORMAL	2	Normal	10-16	2	18-28
HARD	3	Large	18-24	4-6	30-58
VERY HARD	4	Huge	26+	8+	60+

Step 3: Special

You can choose a special property that the monster may have. These include things like modes of travel, resistances or vulnerabilities, any magical abilities or even as simple as “wears armor and carries a weapon”. Below describes what is the most used in the game but is not a complete list and is just meant to spark your imagination.

- **Travel:** Does the monster have wings for flight? Can it swim, dig or climb? Or does it have none of these extra qualities?
- **Illusion:** Can the monster shapeshift or turn invisible?
- **Resistances:** Is the monster resistant to non-magical weapons? Is the monster resistant to weapons that are not silver or jade? Does the monster take no damage or half damage from certain attacks. It is up to you.
- **Vulnerabilities:** Does the monster take damage from sunlight or does the monster take extra damage when attacked with fire?
- **Detection:** Does the monster have heightened senses that makes it difficult to sneak up on? Many eyes, Heart vision, or heightened smell?
- **Magical abilities:** Can the monster enchant its victims to do its bidding(Naiad)? Does it cast magic like a fireball or lightning attack(Dragon or Sea Giant)? Does it steal HP or Willpower with a cold attack(Vampire)?

Step 4: Attacks

The last step you will pick will be 6 monster attacks (or 3 if you plan on making a swarm). You’ll want to think of the monster you are creating and imagine it in a scenario and what will be at its disposal in a fight. Below describes what is used the most currently in the game but this list should not limit your imagination. When writing out an attack make sure you are descriptive because it will add to the fun and tension of the fight.

Standard Attack:

An attack that deals damage. These attacks can target a single player or can target multiple. A bite will likely target one player, and the sweeping of a claw or weapon could attack multiple players.

Things that can be used to attack:

- Claws
- Teeth
- Tail
- Horns
- Objects in a room
- Wind from powerful wings flapping.
- Weapons (swords, axes, hammers, etc)
- Magical attacks (fire, ice, lightning, etc)
- Bad breath or a scream can deal damage
- Or just about anything if it is described the right way.

Fear:

Monsters are quite frightening and often trigger a fear attack. Fear attacks are described on p.52 and 53 of the core rule book. A roar or a scream could affect multiple players. If it is an area effect fear attack you will want to choose the range (10-20 meters). A fear attack can also be directed at a single player (Example: a menacing stare or a monster taunting the player).

Condition:

Monsters can apply a condition to a player character. Choose one or two from the list on p.51 of the core rule book. Make it fit for the scenario occurring (Example: bad breath can make a player sickly).

Effects (applied with a standard attack):

Monsters in many cases will apply an additional effect while attacking a player outside of the normal damage the attack does.

- Knocking player Prone (Minotaur - Horn Rush)
- Blinding (Harpy - Eye Gouge)
- Poison (Giant Spider - Poison Sting)
- Gaining a condition (Ghost - Touch of Death)
- Inflicting a fear attack

Control:

A control attack allows the monster to stun (Player skips their turn this round), is grappled (must shake free) or physically makes the player perform an action (mind control).

Special Action:

Some monsters have a special ability that doesn't fall into the other categories. This action can be a movement action (teleport for example) or can be an attack that either steals HP or WP from the player or does a self-heal. These are not strictly defined and just take some thought but should fit the monster's theme.

Parrying & Dispel:

Finally, some general thought should be put into if the attack can be parried or dispelled and should be listed out when writing the attack description.

The table below will help you choose the difficulty of the attacks for the monsters you create. If you are choosing multiple effects one attack could have from different categories, the highest difficulty will decide the result of the attack. For example, if you choose an attack deals 1d8 damage and stuns the player it will be a hard attack.

DIFFICULTY	DAMAGE	NUMBER OF EFFECTS	POISON	EFFECT	TARGETS
WEAK	1dX - 2d4	-	0	Condition	-
NORMAL	2d6 - 2d8	Attack	9	Fear	Single
HARD	2d10	Attack + 1 Effect	12	Stun or Grapple	Multiple
VERY HARD	3d6+, 3d8+, 3d10+	Attack + 2 Effect	15+	Control	-

Example Monster Created Below:

MIMIC



Ferocity: 2	**Size:** Normal	
Movement: 8	**Armor:** -	**HP:** 24
Shapeshifter: At any time, a mimic can shapeshift into any object of Normal size. This is usually an inanimate object like a chair, table or it's favorite which is a treasure chest. Shapeshifting takes an action. SENSE MAGIC can reveal that the item is a mimic.		

D6	ATTACK
1	**Ravaging Bite!** The mimic bites a player character with its razor-sharp teeth. The attack inflicts 2D8 slashing damage.
2	**Coin Spit!** The mimic clears its throat and spits a gold coin hard at an opponent within 6 meters and laughs maniacally. The attack inflicts D8 bludgeoning damage, and the victim suffers the sickly condition, but becomes one gold coin richer.
3	**Tongue Throw!** The mimic whips its tongue out and grabs an enemy and tosses the victim like a rag doll 2D6 meters in a random direction, inflicting an equal amount of bludgeoning damage. The victim lands prone.
4	**Rotten Breath!** The mimic burps its foul breath at an opponent within 4 meters. The victim becomes Sickly and must succeed with a CON roll (now with a bane) or lose their turn in the round (if it has not already passed).
5	**Stomping Rampage!** The mimic stomps wildly at all opponents within 2 meters. The attack inflicts 2D6 bludgeoning damage and knocks the victims down.
6	**Mimic Snack!** The mimic opens its mouth and bites an enemy, inflicting 2D8 piercing damage. The victim is then stuck in its maw and must make a STR roll (as an action) each round to break free. On failure, the victim suffers an additional 2D8 damage.